

Sales Training — Session 46

Belief Creates Conviction.

You Can't Sell What You Don't Believe.

Marketing Sweet · Sales Training

WHAT THIS SESSION IS The question every rep will be asked — "Why should I choose Marketing Sweet?" — cannot be answered by a script. It can only be answered by a rep who has done the internal work of building their own belief. This session is about how conviction actually gets built, why authenticity beats rehearsal every time, and what the difference sounds like on the other end of a phone.

1. The question underneath the question

When a prospect asks "Why should I choose Marketing Sweet?" — most reps hear a request for features. Customer service. Years in business. Client count. Awards. Those things are all true, they're all defensible, and they're almost never what the prospect is actually asking.

The real question is quieter. "Can I trust you? Will you look after my business? Are you different from everyone else who has already disappointed me?" The rep who answers the feature question misses the actual conversation. The rep who answers the trust question wins the meeting — regardless of how neatly they list the features.

"When a client asks why they should choose us, they're rarely asking about SEO or websites or rankings. They're asking whether they can trust you."

2. Why the script fails — and what buyers actually hear

A script gives a rep words. It doesn't give them conviction. On a live call, the difference between recited words and believed words is audible within the first sentence. Rehearsed sounds like performance. Believed sounds like a person who has thought about this and reached a conclusion they're willing to stand behind.

Buyers have been through enough sales conversations to know the difference immediately. They may not name it — they may not say "you sound scripted" out loud — but the trust conversation ends the moment they detect performance. From that point on, no feature list will rescue the call.

"A script gives you words. It doesn't give you conviction. Clients can hear the difference immediately."

3. Ten reps, ten answers — and why that's the goal

If ten reps on the team were asked "What makes Marketing Sweet different?", the correct outcome isn't ten identical answers — it's ten slightly different answers, each of them true, each of them anchored in something that particular rep genuinely believes.

Some will lead with customer service. Others with transparency. Others with the culture. Others with the results. Others with the honesty of admitting the business is still improving rather than pretending it's already perfect. None of those answers are wrong. What makes them work is that they're real to the person saying them — and reality is what carries conviction across a phone line.

"None of those answers are wrong. The important thing is they're real to you."

4. Find the reason that resonates with you

The rep's job in this session isn't to memorise the "official" reasons Marketing Sweet is different. It's to work out which of the true reasons resonates with them specifically. Because the resonant reason is the one they'll communicate with real energy — and energy is what the prospect responds to.

Every rep should be able to complete the sentence "The reason I actually believe in this business is _____" — and the blank should be filled with something specific. Not "we're a great team" but a moment, a decision, a client outcome, a value the rep has personally seen the business honour. Specific belief is loud. Generic belief is background noise.

5. Rapport is not likeability — it's recognition

A widespread misunderstanding: reps think rapport means being liked. It doesn't. Rapport is showing a client you understand what they're already thinking before they say it out loud. That recognition — "this person gets it" — is what unlocks the conversation.

When a prospect says they're sceptical, they're almost never sceptical because of the rep in front of them. They're sceptical because of what happened before. Someone overpromised. Someone underdelivered. Someone stopped answering the phone. Someone took the money and disappeared. If the rep names that pattern before the prospect has to explain it, the connection forms instantly.

"Rapport is showing someone that you understand what they're already thinking."

6. Be curious, not defensive

The instinct when a prospect pushes back is to defend the company. That instinct is wrong. Defence signals fragility — as if the rep expected the objection to land and needed to shield the business from it. Curiosity signals the opposite: confidence, and a genuine interest in the prospect's story.

Three questions every rep should be comfortable asking:

1. "What happened with your last agency?"
2. "What frustrated you most?"

3. "If you could change one thing about that experience, what would it be?"

The answers do more than gather information. They tell the prospect that this conversation is going to be different from the last one — because the rep is actually interested in the answer, not just waiting for their turn to pitch.

7. Confidence is competence in action

Confidence doesn't come from talking more. It comes from knowing more. The better a rep understands the business, the services, the processes, the results, the values — the more naturally confidence appears in the way they speak. There's no shortcut, and there's no performance trick that substitutes for it.

The reliable test: when a difficult question lands, does the rep panic or welcome it? A rep who has done the internal work welcomes the question. It's a chance to demonstrate what they know. A rep who hasn't done the work goes vague, redirects, or falls back on script. Prospects can feel the difference every single time.

"Confidence is simply competence in action. When you know your material, you don't panic when difficult questions come up. You welcome them."

8. Training ends. The work doesn't.

The rep's responsibility for building belief does not stop when the training session ends. It starts there. The invitation is to go and investigate.

- Speak with different departments — CS, delivery, design, SEO.
- Sit in on onboarding. Understand what a new client actually experiences in the first 30 days.
- Learn the website process end-to-end. Ask what happens after the sale.
- Read client reviews. Read the negative ones too — belief that's built on selective evidence collapses the first time a prospect raises the negative side.
- Ask questions. If something doesn't make sense, don't ignore it — find the answer.

Belief is built from evidence. The more evidence a rep has personally seen, the harder their belief becomes to shake — and the more naturally it comes through in the call.

9. Why struggling reps struggle — the belief gap

The single largest reason reps struggle isn't a lack of ability. It's the belief gap. They're trying to sell something they haven't fully bought into themselves. They're uncertain. And uncertainty transfers.

Energy transfers between people in a conversation — positive or negative. If the rep is unsure, the prospect becomes unsure. If the rep is confident, the prospect feels more

confident too. This isn't manipulation. It's basic human perception. Prospects use the rep's own certainty as a signal for whether the underlying thing is worth trusting.

"If you're unsure, your client becomes unsure. If you're confident, your client feels more confident too. Energy transfers between people."

10. The actor analogy — convinced, not convincing

Actors don't memorise lines and hope the audience buys it. Great actors become the character. That's why the performance feels believable — the audience forgets they're watching a performance at all.

The parallel for a sales rep isn't about pretending. It's about doing enough internal work that the belief becomes real. When belief is real, the rep doesn't sound convincing. They ARE convinced. There's a huge difference between the two, and prospects can feel the difference in the first thirty seconds of a call.

11. Healthy scepticism — with a shelf life

Reps should question things. Challenge ideas. Do their own research. Not believing something simply because someone said it is a sign of thinking, not disloyalty. That's healthy.

But scepticism has a shelf life. At some point, the rep has to investigate — go and check for themselves. Scepticism that never becomes investigation is just doubt in a nicer jacket. Doubt doesn't close deals. Investigated belief does.

"Scepticism without action is just doubt. And doubt never closes deals."

12. Certainty, backed by evidence

The strongest way to answer "why should I choose Marketing Sweet?" is certainty that's clearly backed by evidence the rep has personally seen. Not scripted talking points delivered on autopilot — the same points delivered by a person who has walked through the reasons and can defend each one.

The evidence pool is deep:

- The track record — years in the market, industries served, work done.
- Client relationships — long-standing partnerships that speak louder than any pitch.
- Reviews — real feedback from real Australian businesses, publicly visible.
- Customer service commitment — what actually happens when a client rings up with a problem.
- Systems built — the processes that make delivery consistent instead of one-off.
- Continuous improvement — the willingness to look at what isn't working and fix it, rather than pretend it's already perfect.

None of these matter as talking points. They matter as reasons the rep has personally investigated and decided to stand behind.

13. Today's challenge

Don't try to memorise better scripts. Build stronger belief. Learn the company from the inside. Understand the values, not just the words on the website. Research the processes. Ask better questions of the people around you. Find your own reasons for believing in what we do.

When belief becomes genuine, confidence becomes natural. Conversations become effortless. And prospects don't just hear the words — they believe them, because the person saying them clearly does.

"When your belief becomes genuine, your confidence becomes natural. Your conversations become effortless. And your clients won't just hear your words — they'll believe them too."

Action items — this week

1. Write down your own reason. One sentence, specific. "The reason I actually believe in this business is _____." If you can't finish the sentence, that's the work.
2. Book one internal conversation. Pick a department you haven't spent time in — CS, delivery, onboarding, design — and sit with them for 30 minutes.
3. Read ten reviews. Not just the five-star ones. Look for the objection you're most afraid a prospect will raise, and make sure you can answer it honestly.
4. Rehearse the three curiosity questions. "What happened with your last agency?" / "What frustrated you most?" / "If you could change one thing, what would it be?" — get comfortable asking them without sounding rehearsed.
5. On your next difficult call, notice the moment you feel the urge to defend. Ask a question instead. Report back on what happened.